

Tweets and ads

Angry developers of Twitter have vowed to make their own platform, after Twitter started support for advertisements

New Macbooks

Apple have refreshed their notebook range with Core i5 and i7-based notebooks with improved GPUs and battery backup

Bazaar

Buffalo HD PXT320U2

Turbo charged portable drive

The Buffalo Mini-Station Metro HD PXT320U2 is a portable 320GB hard drive which is a successor to the HD-PXU2 series. The T represents Turbo mode which claims to double transfer rates. The hard drive comes with an inbuilt partition which has the turbo PC and hardware encryption programs. Hardware encryption allows you to encrypt your data with a 64-bit Advanced Encryption

Standard key. Coming in an all black body with a glossy front and a rubberised matte finish on the rear, this drive looks striking. It has a flex connect USB cable which connects into the chassis. It also comes with an extendable USB cable.

The test system comprised of an Intel DX58SO motherboard, Kingston 6 GB DDR3 RAM, a WD Velociraptor 500GB hard drive and a Corsair HX620W power supply. The real life tests like data



transfer showed and improvement in the turbo mode as can be seen from the tables.

At Rs.9,000 we feel it is costly even for the performance. It's for those who want high data transfer speeds but do not want to purchase the more expensive USB 3.0 drives just yet.

CORRIGENDUM

On Page 79 in the April 2010 issue, the correct price of the Novatron NTD38 is Rs. 13,500.

Specifications

Dimensions (WxDxH) mm : 135x91x20; Weight : 240g ; Power consumption : 2.5 W; Software bundled : Turbo PC, Picasso

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Web site: www.buffalotech.com

Price: Rs. 9,000

Tests	Normal mode	Turbo mode
File Write 4 GB Single File (secs)	156	120
File Write Test Assorted 4 GB File (secs)	234	128
Read Test Single 4 GB File (secs)	133	100
Read Test Assorted 4 GB File (secs)	141	104

*Less is better

6/10

Features.....7
Performance.....7
Build quality.....7.5
Value for money.....4.5

Gigabyte GA-D510UD

An entry level Mini ITX motherboard

Specifications

Intel Atom D510 processor; Express NM10 chipset; one IDE port; one PCI slot; four SATA 2.0 ports; four USB ports

Contact

GIGABYTE Technology

Phone: +91-22-4063 3222

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Price: Rs. 5,500

7/10

Features.....6
Performance.....7
Build quality.....7
Value for money.....7.5

Gigabyte GA-D510UD is a mini ITX form factor motherboard that houses a dual core Intel Atom D510 processor. The D510 supports hyper-threading which allows the two cores on the 45nm die to run four threads simultaneously. GA510UD is based on the Express NM10 chipset and the processor runs at 1.66GHz. The layout of the motherboard is pretty neat. The processor is covered by a heatsink and a fan is located on top of it.

The board has four SATA 2.0 ports, an IDE port which seems redundant. A PCI

slot is present perpendicular to the two DIMM slots which can house upto 4 GB of DDR2 RAM.

Two PS/2 ports for the mouse and keyboard seems unnecessary, a three port audio jack and four USB ports are also present on the rear side of the board.

We used a Corsair Dominator 2GB DDR2 RAM for carrying out the real life tests. In the synthetic tests like PCMark 05 it gave a score of 2630. Real life tests like compression/decompression gave 563 KB/s whereas data transfer takes place at 47 Mbps (4GB



sequential file) and 40Mbps (4GB assorted file).

The economical pricing of Rs 5,500 for a dual core processor is a good one for those looking to buy a separate machine for their basic computing needs.